3. A description of what, in my opinion, was happening in the halls of government in Tehran. In my final analysis, I expressed the opinion that their intention was to reach military nuclear capability and that they were more determined than ever. I also emphasized the changes in the country's power structure, which was on its way to becoming a "praetorian" regime of the IRGC, to which the clerics would be held hostage.
4. An analysis of what was happening in the corridors of government in Moscow; I came to the conclusion that Iran was a bargaining chip between Russia and the United States, with the former agreeing to join an American coalition against Iran only if the United States recognized Russia as a world power of equal standing and influence.
5. An analysis of the possible courses of action against the Iranian nuclear threat, a list of priorities, and what would happen "the day after" if any action would be taken.

Iran: The Domestic Picture

In 2010 the Iranian regime was a multilayered hybrid creature with so many duplications in its system that it was difficult to discern who held the authority, not only formally, but de facto. The Iranian regime was neither a democracy nor a totalitarian regime but rather a strange combination of both. An Iranian scholar who was once asked who controlled Iran answered, "Everyone and no one!" On the surface, it appeared that the government was completely subordinate to the clerics. This was true immediately following the Khomeini revolution in 1979, but since then the situation had changed, in light of the erosion of the clerics' power and the rise of militant elites fighting for power and influence and navigating between religious orders, political laws, personal ties, and bureaucratic directives.

At the center of all the circles of influence was the Supreme Leader Khamenei. However, he was surrounded by the clerics, the government, and senior military officials, a total of about 10 percent of the country's population—close to seventy-five million citizens. Obviously, in the presence of such a large and diverse group of elites, even the supreme spiritual leader found himself facing challenges and dilemmas in exercising